

900 per cent

That's how much global Android smartphone shipments will grow in 2009, says new research by Strategy Analytics

Feature

users have taken to uploading photos from their cell phones directly; a variant of image blogging.

The text boxes on Facebook are a problem, but there's always a work around such as installing a dedicated Facebook app from Mobile Facebook. Mobile internet enthusiasts will also go to random web sites such as icanhascheezburger.com.

DO this

Set up your own file server

Using a simple 600 kb free open source application called HFS (Http File Server), you can have access to your files and folders from your mobile phone. Download HFS from <http://www.rejetto.com/hfs> and run it. Click Menu > Add



folder from disk. Choose which folders you would want to access remotely. You can also add entire drives. Right-click on the drive and set a username and password. Now if you enter your IP address from your mobile's browser, you will have access to your entire hard drive displayed in tree structure format.

[com, failblog.org](http://com.failblog.org) or the Photoshop Disaster blog, and basically find various means to stay entertained. This includes getting on to YouTube.com and streaming videos. YouTube video is best viewed if you are stationary because switching between transmission towers reduces the effective transmission speeds. But YouTube has recently implemented a Flash-based interface for mobile phones, by which you can pause your video so that it buffers and you get to watch it uninterrupted. Earlier, when streaming with Real Player, the videos would frequently stop. YouTube is very popular with the *always on* crowd because every now and then when you're with friends,

and there is some interesting clip that you want to show, it makes for good conversation starter.

Another advantage of Advanced GPRS is that you can connect your laptop to the phone and use the phone as a modem. This way you can use the phone's internet via your laptop even for playing online games. For games such as *Red Alert 3* you can join the game lobby and have an online match anytime. Some of the carriers indeed provide connections that are fast enough for online games. Of course in every city you'll have dead spots where you get little or no GPRS connectivity.

Give me more

Many people buy phones with large storage capacity in the hope of carrying along all of their music; but let's face it, there will always something that you'll find left behind and miss. Perhaps you just got your hands on that latest album and forgot to transfer it to your phone or maybe it's that classic you removed from your flash card to make way for that new single, but are now craving for. Is there a way to have your entire music collection follow you around? With phones enabled with internet connectivity it's easily possible. Mihir Pathare, a self-confessed information junkie and *always on* addict uses something known as *Winamp Remote* to stream his music to his phone remotely. "I've set up my own web server at home, since my PC is always switched on and online. So what *Winamp Remote* does is it takes my entire media library and streams it to me", he says. Once the user logs into *Winamp Remote* it will broadcast the song to the users' phone at the maximum bitrate the connection supports at that point of time.

So if you're in a Wi-Fi hot spot with a compatible phone, your music will stream at 128 kbps or even 320 kbps, while if you are connected via the GPRS packet service, you can set the bit rate limit at say 60 kbps depending on the strength and bandwidth of the connection. While travelling, when your connection changes cell sites frequently it is recommended to keep the bit rate low such that there's the least chance of interruption. 40 kbps is the least bitrate that you can set. Another alternative is

to listen to internet radio. On Nokia N-series phones, for example, internet radio comes inbuilt. There are also Java and Symbian applications such as *VRadio* which has 200

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